09-25 第二篇

Polar Bears and Global Warming

Polar bears are among the most iconic animals of the Arctic. They depend on sea ice to hunt seals, travel, and raise their young. Yet the Arctic is warming faster than almost anywhere else on Earth, and the ice is melting. [1] As the ice disappears, polar bears face a growing threat to their survival that humans have the power to reduce.

Sea ice forms when the ocean freezes in winter. Polar bears use this ice as a platform to catch seals when they surface to breathe. In summer, some ice melts, but polar bears have adapted to fast during the lean months. [2] When winters become shorter and summers longer, bears have less time to hunt and more time without food, which weakens them and reduces the number of cubs that survive.

Scientists have been tracking polar bear populations for decades. They use satellite collars, aerial surveys, and direct observation to understand how the bears are doing. The results show that in areas where ice loss is severe, bear numbers are declining. [3] Research gives us the data we need to make informed decisions about how to protect these animals and their habitat.

Protecting polar bears means protecting their habitat. Reducing greenhouse gas emissions, supporting clean energy, and backing policies that limit warming are all important steps. Individual choices, such as using less electricity and driving less, also add up. [4] Everyone can contribute to solutions that slow climate change and give polar bears a fighting chance.

Polar bears are not the only species affected by a warming Arctic. Seals, walruses, and many other animals depend on the ice as well. What happens to the Arctic affects the whole planet. [5] Acting now to protect polar bears and their home is part of protecting our shared future on Earth.

选项

A. Human-caused climate change is putting these magnificent animals at risk. B. Changes in ice patterns directly affect how much food polar bears can find. C. Science helps us understand the problem and guides us toward solutions. D. Small actions, when many people do them, can have a real impact on the planet. E. Saving the Arctic is not only about one species—it is about the health of our planet. F. For example, some polar bear populations have declined by more than 30% in the past 20 years.

答案键（Answer Key）

[1] A [2] B [3] C [4] D [5] E

深度解析

- **[1] A**：
  - **线索**：空前指出北极熊依赖海冰，北极变暖、冰融，空后说"As the ice disappears, polar bears face a growing threat to their survival that humans have the power to reduce"。A的"Human-caused climate change is putting these magnificent animals at risk"概括人为气候变化对北极熊的威胁，与"threat"和"humans have the power to reduce"完美呼应。
- **[2] B**：
  - **线索**：空前描述海冰与捕猎的关系及冬夏季节适应，空后强调"When winters become shorter and summers longer, bears have less time to hunt and more time without food"。B的"Changes in ice patterns directly affect how much food polar bears can find"准确概括冰情变化与食物获取的关系，与"less time to hunt"逻辑一致。
- **[3] C**：
  - **线索**：空前列举科研方法（卫星项圈、航空调查、观测）及种群下降的发现，空后说"Research gives us the data we need to make informed decisions about how to protect these animals"。C的"Science helps us understand the problem and guides us toward solutions"概括科学在理解与决策中的作用，与"data"和"informed decisions"对应。
- **[4] D**：
  - **线索**：空前列举保护措施（减排、清洁能源、政策、个人选择），空后强调"Everyone can contribute to solutions that slow climate change and give polar bears a fighting chance"。D的"Small actions, when many people do them, can have a real impact on the planet"概括个人行为累加的效果，与"Individual choices"和"Everyone can contribute"呼应。
- **[5] E**：
  - **线索**：空前指出北极变暖影响多种物种及全球，空后说"Acting now to protect polar bears and their home is part of protecting our shared future on Earth"。E的"Saving the Arctic is not only about one species—it is about the health of our planet"升华主题，与"whole planet"和"shared future"完美对应。
- **干扰项分析**：

- **F. For example, some polar bear populations have declined by more than 30% in the past 20 years.**：以For example开头，属具体举例；各空均为概括或过渡句，F为种群数量下降的数据个案，不适用于任何空位，易误放[1]或[3]，但两空分别需气候变化威胁的概括与科学作用的概括，非举例。